

Title: The Use of Learning Management Systems and Its Effect on Student Engagement in Graduate Classes

Background of the Study

Learning Management Systems are now commonly used in schools and universities to support classroom instruction. Platforms such as Canvas, Moodle, Google Classroom, and other online learning systems allow students to access announcements, submit assignments, take quizzes, download learning materials, and communicate with instructors. These systems became especially important as schools adopted blended and online learning setups.

Although Learning Management Systems provide many useful features, student engagement still depends on how these platforms are used. Some students actively check course updates, participate in online discussions, and submit tasks on time. Others may only log in when deadlines are near. The effectiveness of a Learning Management System depends not only on the technology itself, but also on the student's habits, teacher's use of the platform, course design, and accessibility of learning materials.

This study aims to examine how the use of Learning Management Systems affects student engagement in graduate classes. It focuses on participation, task submission, access to learning materials, communication, and interaction with instructors and classmates.

Statement of the Problem

The main problem addressed by this study is the uneven level of student engagement in classes that use Learning Management Systems. Even when online platforms are available, some students may still have low participation, delayed submissions, or limited interaction. This study seeks to understand how LMS usage influences student engagement and what factors affect active participation.

Research Objectives

This study aims to:

1. Identify the Learning Management System features commonly used by graduate students.
2. Determine how often students access course materials, announcements, and online activities.
3. Assess the relationship between LMS usage and student engagement.
4. Identify challenges students experience when using Learning Management Systems.
5. Recommend ways to improve student engagement through better LMS use.

Proposed Methodology

This study will use a descriptive quantitative research design. A survey questionnaire will be distributed to selected graduate students who use a Learning Management System in their classes. The questionnaire will ask about platform usage, frequency of access, participation in online activities, assignment submission behavior, and communication with instructors.

The study may also include selected open-ended questions to gather student suggestions. Data will be analyzed using frequency, percentage, mean, and ranking. If possible, LMS activity data such as logins, submissions, and participation records may be used as supporting information.

Expected Output

The expected output of this study is a summary of how Learning Management Systems affect student engagement in graduate classes. The study may identify which LMS features are most useful for students and which areas need improvement. It may also provide recommendations for instructors on how to design online activities that encourage better participation.

Significance of the Study

This study may benefit students by identifying ways to improve their engagement in online and blended classes. It may also help instructors use Learning Management Systems more effectively. School administrators may use the findings to improve digital learning policies, platform training, and academic support services.

Keywords

Learning Management System, student engagement, graduate students, online learning, blended learning, Canvas, Moodle, Google Classroom, digital education, academic participation